PRODUCT DESIGN PLAN

The Simple Product Wizard

A guided, plain-language "add a product" flow for non-technical sellers.

The whole idea in one line: capture once, confirm, publish.

The wizard is a friendly front-door to the **same** product the full editor already edits — never a separate system, so anything created here stays fully editable later.
This plan has **two halves**: **Part 1 — Add** (the wizard) and **Part 2 — Finish** (backfilling the gaps so the catalog reaches 100%).

PART ONE — ADD

The Simple Product Wizard

Why this is simple — the 5 levers

- **Stop asking for what a machine can get** — snap a label or paste a blurb, the AI fills the rest.
- **Pick from lists, never type** the structured things (category, size, unit).
- **Auto-generate the scary things** — the product code (SKU) especially.
- **Yes/No gates + smart defaults**; hide everything a beginner doesn't need.
- **Capture-then-confirm, not fill-then-enhance** — the AI goes first, you just check its work.

How it starts — the front door

One friendly question before any form:

How do you want to start?

Snap the label · **Paste a description** · **Copy a product I already sell** · **Start from scratch**

The first three pre-fill almost everything; the wizard then becomes a series of *confirmations*. Only "Start from scratch" shows blank fields.

The flow — a simple product is 4 screens

Forks (sizes, bundle) appear **only** when relevant. Progress is shown as adaptive dots / "almost done" — never a lying "Step 3 of 7."

Screen 1 — What it is

- Name · Category (pre-suggested from the list) · Photo(s)
- *All pre-filled if they snapped/pasted — they just confirm and can swap in a nicer photo.*

Screen 2 — Price & stock

- **Top question (the one real fork):** "Does it come in different sizes/options?" → **No / Yes**
- **No** → Price · How many in stock · *(product code auto-filled, small, editable)*
- **Yes** → opens the **Sizes step**; the single price/stock is replaced by per-size rows
- *On sale?* and *Ships where?* sit here as pre-set chips from your store's usual pattern — tap to change, not questions.

Screen 3 — Details

- One paste/snap box already did the work → facts come in pre-filled: Origin · Ingredients · Storage · Shelf life · Serving · Weight
- **Allergens** ("free of…") — AI suggests from the ingredients, **you tick to confirm**
- **Story** (the marketing description) — optional, the leftover prose from the paste

Screen 4 — Review & publish

- Live preview of the finished product page
- The **look** lives here as a switch, not a step: "Here's your page — [Designed □] [switch to plain]" (designed is the default)
- Green readiness check: □ Photo □ Price □ Category — ready!
- **Put it in the shop** · or **Save as draft, keep editing** · or **Save & add another**

The two forks

- **Sizes step** (when "yes") — rows of *option name · price (pre-filled) · stock · code (auto)*, "+ Add another size," and an "All the same price?" shortcut.
- **Bundle add-on** (optional, before review) — "Offer this in a bundle with other products? (skip)" → pick products + a bundle price. Demoted here because it's rare and changes nothing about the product itself.

Every product field → where it lives (nothing dropped)

Field (today)	Plain name	Treatment	Where
name_en / name_cn	Name	Type one language, AI fills the other	1
images (≤8)	Photos	Upload, or reuse the snapped label; AI picks the clearest as main	1
top_category / subcategory	Section	**Pick from list** (starter set if store is empty)	1
sell_price	Price	One number	2
sku	Product code	**Auto-filled, editable** (migrators type their own)	2
(variants)	Sizes / options	Yes/No fork → per-size price/stock/code	Sizes
compare_at_price	Original price	"On sale?" yes reveals it; default off	2
ship_modes	Ships where	Default **everywhere** (store pattern); toggle **local-only**	2
stock by location	In stock	"How many?" per store *(here only if no sizes)*	2 / Sizes
product_facts (origin, ingredients, storage, shelf life, serving)	Details	**Paste/snap-fill**, then review	3
weight	Weight	Number + **unit dropdown** (g/kg/ml/pcs); AI-extracted	3
free_of	Free of (allergens)	AI suggests → **human confirms** (your guarantee)	3
description_en / cn	Story	Optional; leftover prose from paste	3
use_block_design	Page look	**Default designed**; switch on review	4
is_published	In shop / draft	Decided at the end	4

Field (today)	Plain name	Treatment	Where
status	—	Hidden · default **Active**	hidden
tags (badge)	—	Hidden · default **Auto**	hidden
is_market / is_batch_made / is_restock_only	—	Hidden · default **off** (Roots-specific)	hidden
low_stock_threshold	—	Hidden · **store default**	hidden
notes	—	Not in wizard — full editor only	—

New-user safety nets (the edge cases that actually bite)

- **Empty store → no categories to pick.** The first-ever product offers a small **starter set**, or a one-tap "create this section now."
- **Single-language store** → the other language's boxes never appear.
- **Never an error — prevent it.** Auto-code kills "SKU required"; a clash gets a gentle inline nudge. No photo? → "Add one, or save as draft."
- **Draft-first, nothing lost.** A draft is created as soon as there's a name; it only goes live at Screen 4.
- **"Open the full editor" door on every screen** — the wizard is the *simple mode*, not a cage.
- **Allergen claims = the seller's promise.** Only pre-tick when ingredients look complete; otherwise "tick only what you can guarantee."

What already exists vs. what's new

Reused (low risk — the engine is built): the fact boxes + "auto-fill from text" AI, the **Design: On** compose step, **Duplicate** (powers Copy-existing), per-store stock, the category lists, the SKU-uniqueness check.

New build	Effort
The wizard shell + 4-screen flow + the front-door chooser	Moderate
Store-pattern defaults (learn shipping/allergens/category from your products)	Moderate
Live preview that fills as you go	Moderate
Starter categories for empty stores	Small
Plain-word relabel layer	Small
Snap-the-label (vision) — the "whoa" feature	Bigger

Suggested build order

v1 — magic but buildable: Front-door chooser → **Copy-existing** + **Paste-to-fill** (mostly there) → the 4-screen spine → **store-pattern defaults** → **single-language hide** → **live preview** + **plain words** + **skip-everything** → **starter categories**.

Fast-follow: Snap-the-label vision (the hero), per-store nuance, "Save & add another" momentum loop.

PART TWO — FINISH

Finish your products

The other half of the loop. The wizard is deliberately permissive ("skip — add later"), so it *creates* gaps by design. This is the cleanup surface that pays the debt down — so "add later" never becomes "never" — and gets every product to 100%.

The one move that makes it work: approve, don't type

If this page just lists gaps and asks people to type, nobody with 200 products ever finishes. The unlock: **most gaps, the AI can propose an answer to** — the user just taps □. So split every gap into two kinds:

AI can propose — just approve	Only you know — you supply
Storage · shelf life · serving · ingredients · weight · the other language (translate) · allergens (from ingredients) · category (from the name) · story (from the facts)	Price · a real photo · true origin · the real product code

A "Let AI fill every gap it can → you review" button can take a catalog from 60% to 95% in one pass. The human then only deals with the handful a machine genuinely can't know.

The interaction: a gap queue, batched by field

Not product-by-product (too much context-switching). Lead with **one field across many products** — a fast rhythm where you stay in one headspace:

> "30 products have no storage info. Here are the AI's suggestions — approve them all, or fix as you go."
>
> Each card: thumbnail + name · the field · the **editable AI suggestion** · [□ Looks good] [Edit] [Doesn't apply] [Skip]. Next. Thumb-friendly, progress dots. **Bulk-approve** a whole field at once. (You can still open a single product and fill all its gaps — but batch-by-field is the power mode.)

What counts as "missing" — and the rules that keep it honest

- **"Doesn't apply" must reach 100%.** A service has no shelf life; some products have no allergens to declare. If there's no way to say N/A, the meter never hits 100% and people tune it out. Marking N/A satisfies completeness **and is remembered**, so it never asks again.
- **Only shopper-facing fields count.** It covers the full set *including ones the wizard skipped* (weight, badge, shipping, allergens), but **never** internal toggles (internal notes, low-stock threshold, Roots-only flags). Otherwise the score punishes you for things shoppers never see.
- **It descends into variants.** A size with no price or no stock is a real, sellable-blocking gap.

Lead with impact, not volume

Priority	What
Can't sell well — do first	Missing photo, price, or category. *"5 products need your attention."*
Worth polishing — the AI batch	Missing facts, story, weight, allergens.

A per-product completeness % and a store-wide meter that **climbs as you go** — gentle motivation, not a scold. **Decided:** the meter is *gently visible* — a small "87%" on the Products page that climbs, never a nag.

It reuses the wizard — and frees it to be lazier

Same field definitions, same plain-word labels, same AI (extract-facts / compose / translate), same save endpoints, even the same snap/paste on-ramps applied to *existing* products. And because this safety net exists, the **wizard can be even more permissive** — "just name + photo + price, do the rest later" — knowing nothing falls through the cracks.

It already has a real job at Roots

~102 product descriptions were imported from the old store, but those products mostly *don't have the structured facts* (origin / storage / shelf life as boxes) — the info is trapped in prose. This page is exactly the tool to **bulk-extract structured facts from existing descriptions** with AI, review, done. Day-one work, not hypothetical.

A v1 that's mostly AI + a queue

- A **completeness score** + a banner on the Products page: "23 products are missing info — finish them."
- The **gap queue**, batched by field, with **AI-suggested answers** and **bulk-approve**.
- **Easy photo upload** + a clear **price/category** nudge for the human-only gaps.
- **"Doesn't apply"** with memory.

"Finish your products" turns "add later" into a catalog that actually reaches 100%.

PART THREE — IMPORT

Bring your products in

The switching-platforms moment. A seller arrives with 200 products already living somewhere else. The rule: **they never reformat their data to fit us — we read whatever they have, they confirm once, it lands as drafts, and Part 2 finishes the gaps.** Import is just the wizard at scale, on the same engine.

If they have a sheet (any structure)

AI-mapped import — five steps, and the only human step is one confirmation:

- **Drop the file** — any .xlsx/.csv, any column order or names ("Title," "Item," English or Chinese headers), messy or clean.
- **AI maps their columns → our fields**; you **confirm the mapping once** (not per row). This is what makes it correct *regardless* of structure — the AI bends to their layout, the human sanity-checks the map.
- **Clean & normalize** — strip ¥/$, parse "200 g" → 200 + unit, split combined cells, detect EN vs CN.
- **Preview as draft products** — scan, fix inline, see flags ("row 14 has no price," "this ¥4500 looks like a typo").
- **Import as DRAFTS** — never auto-publish, with one-click **undo this import**.

The three things that actually go wrong in real sheets — and the fix

- **Images.** Sheets rarely hold real photos. URLs → we fetch them; filenames → **"drag your images folder, we match by filename/SKU"**; nothing → photos become the top human-only gap in Part 2.
- **Variants.** Sizes appear as *multiple rows* or as *columns* — AI detects which and groups them; you confirm.
- **Languages.** One language present → AI fills the other; both present → maps each to EN/CN.

Two guarantees: **nothing is silently dropped** (an unrecognized column is parked, never deleted) and **dedupe by SKU/name** so a re-import updates instead of doubling.

If they don't have a sheet

The informal seller — products live on a phone, in WeChat, on Taobao, or in their head. On-ramps, easiest first:

- **Photos-first bulk add (strongest).** "Drop all your product photos" → each photo → AI vision makes a draft (name / ingredients / weight from the label; you add price). The wizard's snap-the-label, in bulk.
- **Import from their existing online store.** Paste shop / product **links** (Taobao / Youzan / another mini-program / website) → AI reads the public pages → drafts. The real platform-switch answer.
- **Paste whatever they've got.** A WeChat message, a typed list, a document → AI parses it into rows.
- **Just use the wizard** for a handful — bulk tools are for volume.

Build it, or plug in a market tool?

There is a whole category of embeddable AI CSV importers — **Flatfile, OneSchema, Osmos, Dromo, Nuvo/Ingestro, CSVBox**, open-source **YoBulk**. They do real column-mapping, but for this product the recommendation is to **build thin on Claude**, not plug one in:

Why build on the engine you already have	What a market tool would (and wouldn't) add
You already own the intelligence — column-mapping, normalizing, parsing text, reading photos — wired in through the model gateway. White-label single-vendor stays intact. Customer data stays on your China stack (PIPL / latency).	Saves the mapping/validation *widget UI* only — not the brains. Adds a 2nd AI vendor, a monthly + per-row cost, and (mostly) ships catalogs to US servers. Covers Case A only — nothing for photos / links / paste.

Only revisit a tool if you want to skip building the import widget — then look at **Dromo** (zero-retention) or self-host **YoBulk** (open-source) to keep data off a third party. Note: the China platforms (Youzan / Weidian / Taobao) have no turnkey catalog-API agent — your link-import + AI is as good as it gets.

A v1 for import

AI-mapped CSV/XLSX import (the confirm-the-mapping flow) + **photos-first bulk add** — those two cover "I have a sheet" and "I have photos but no sheet." **Fast-follow:** import-from-link (platform switchers) and drag-your-image-folder matching.

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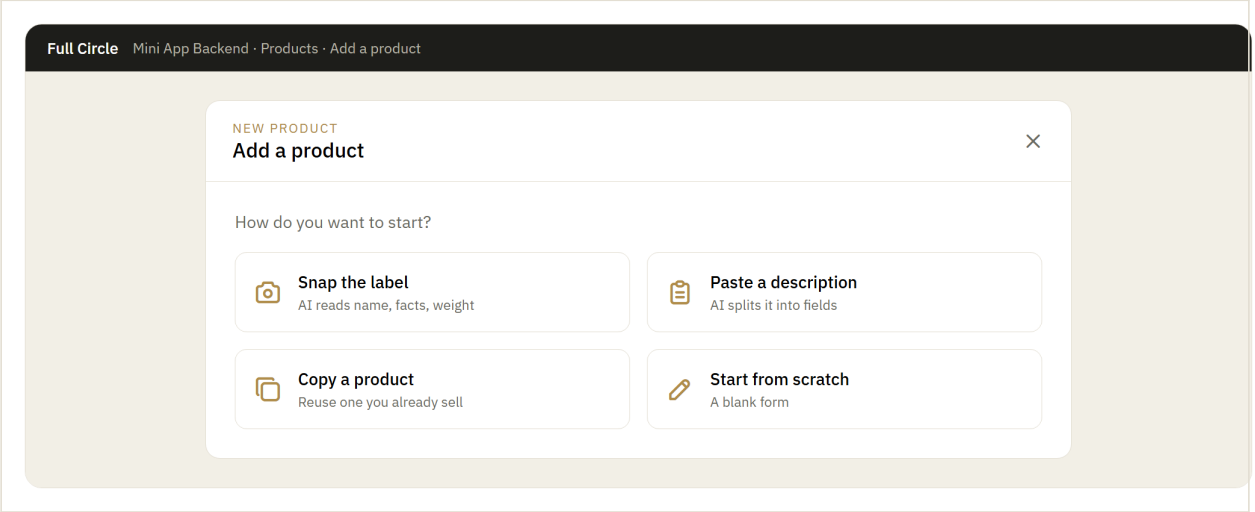
*Three steps of one loop — **Add** fast, **Finish** the gaps, **Import** at scale — all on the same engine (Claude, already wired in), all landing as drafts you control.*

THE SCREENS

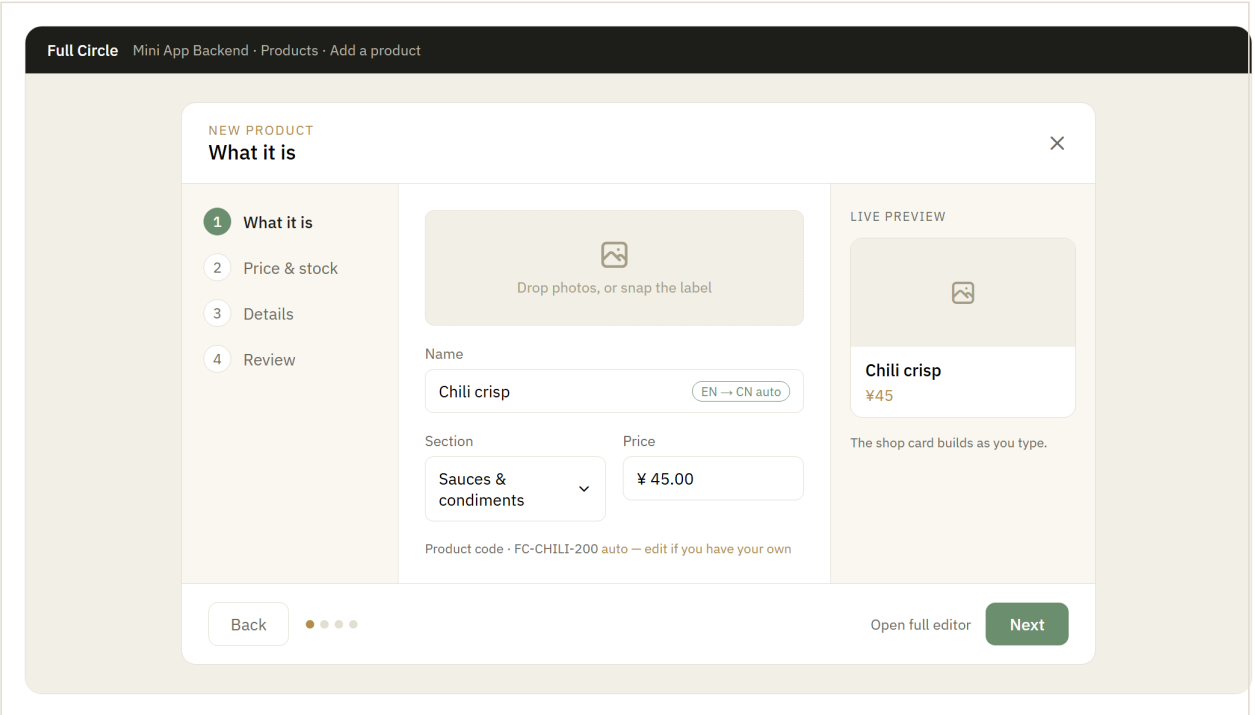
What it looks like

Mockups in the Full Circle backend palette (Ink / Brass / Tea, IBM Plex). Phone-first for operators on the move; the same flow on desktop gains a step rail and a live preview that builds as you type.

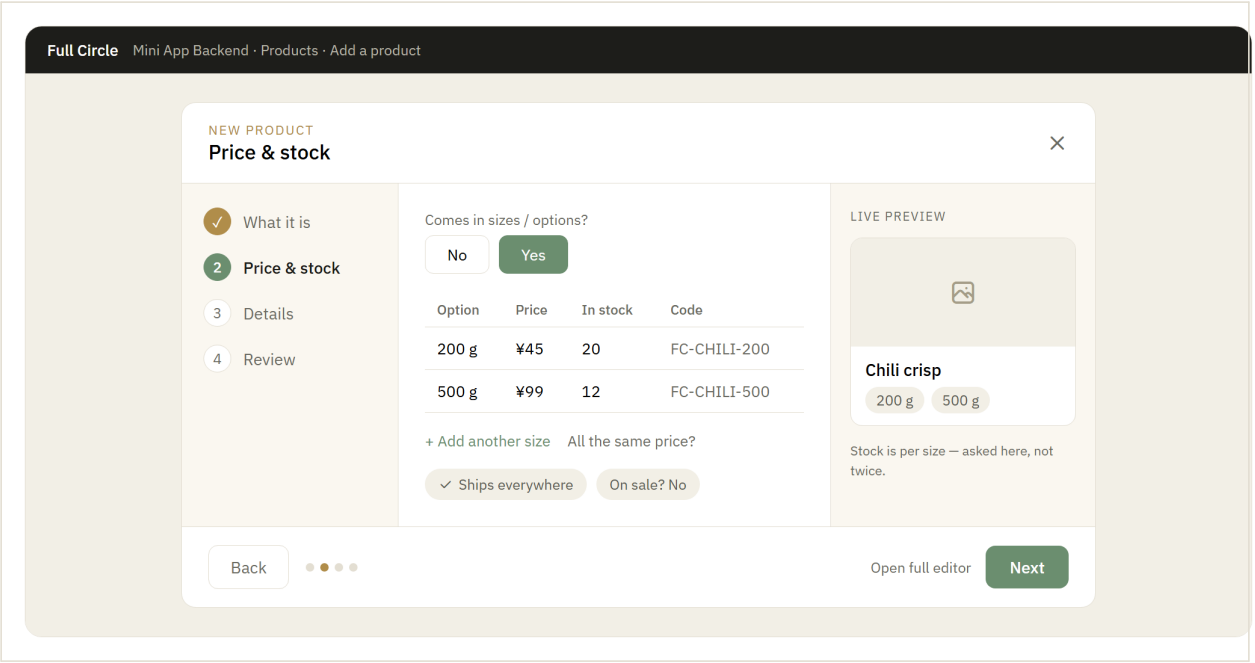
Desktop flow — the PC version, screen by screen



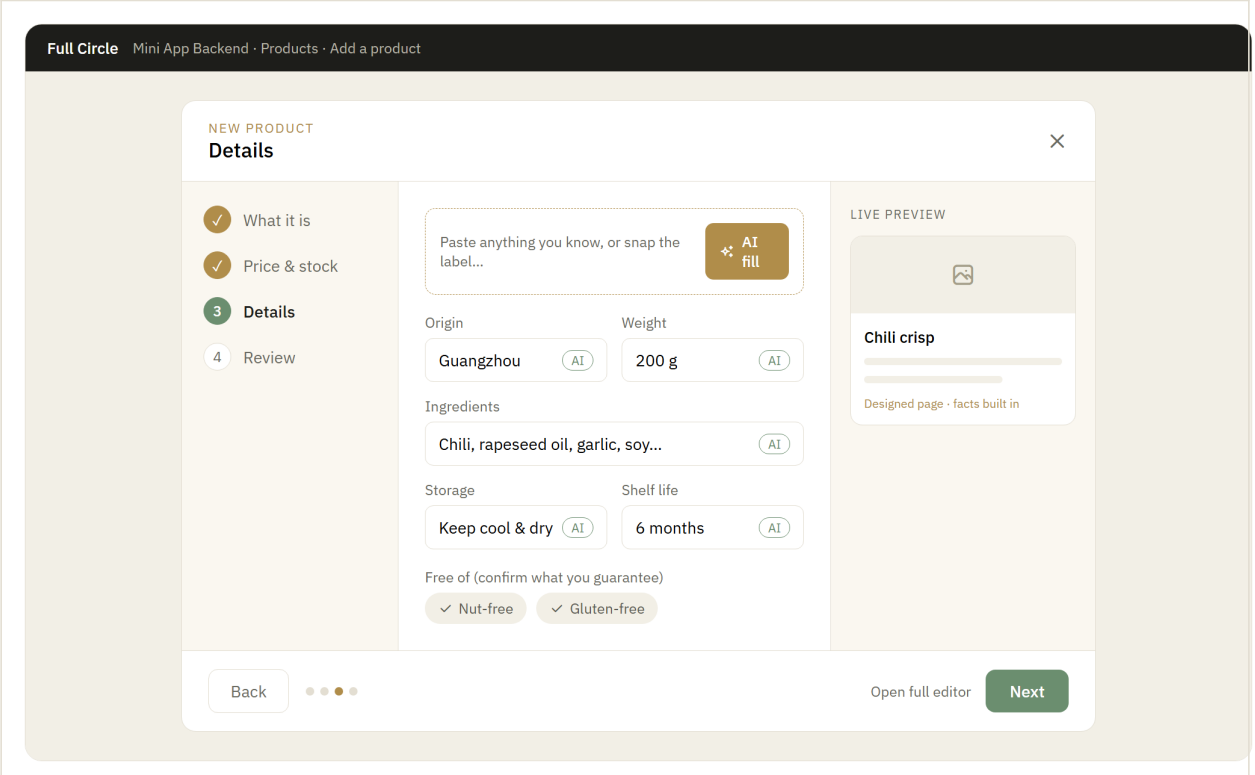
Front door — meet people where their product already lives.



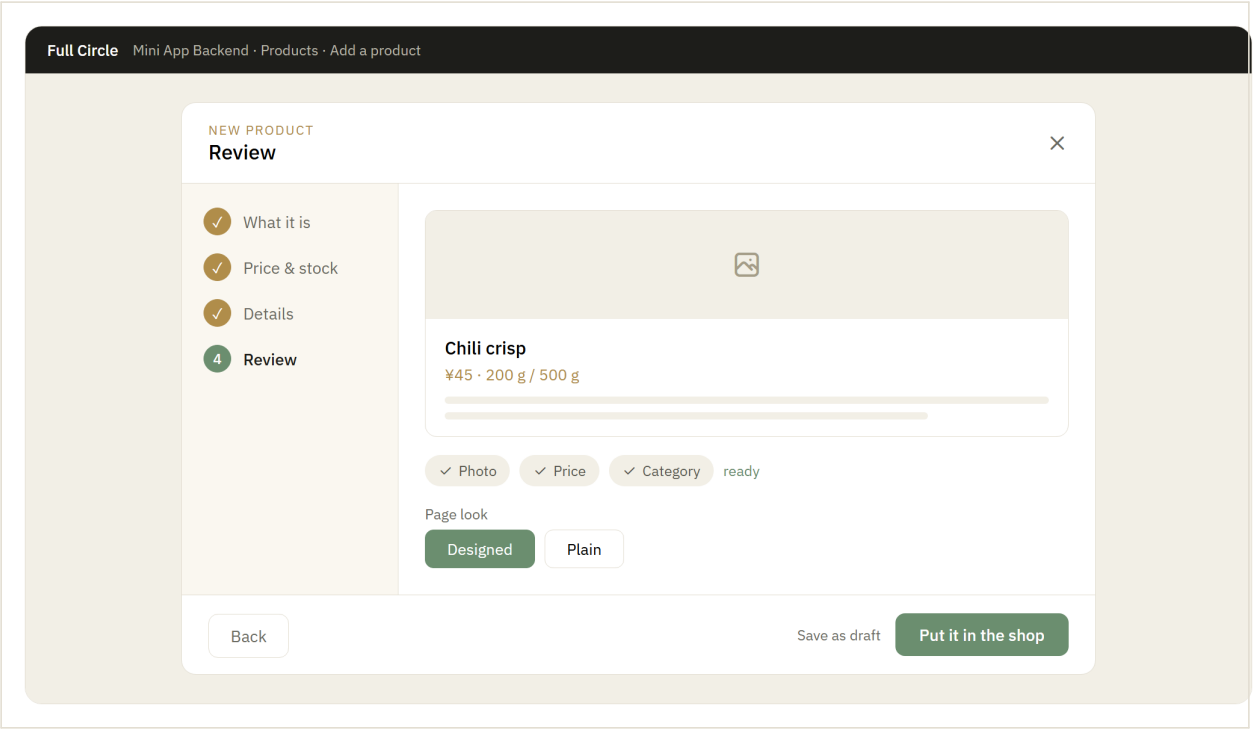
Step 1 — What it is. Pre-filled if they snapped or pasted; just confirm.



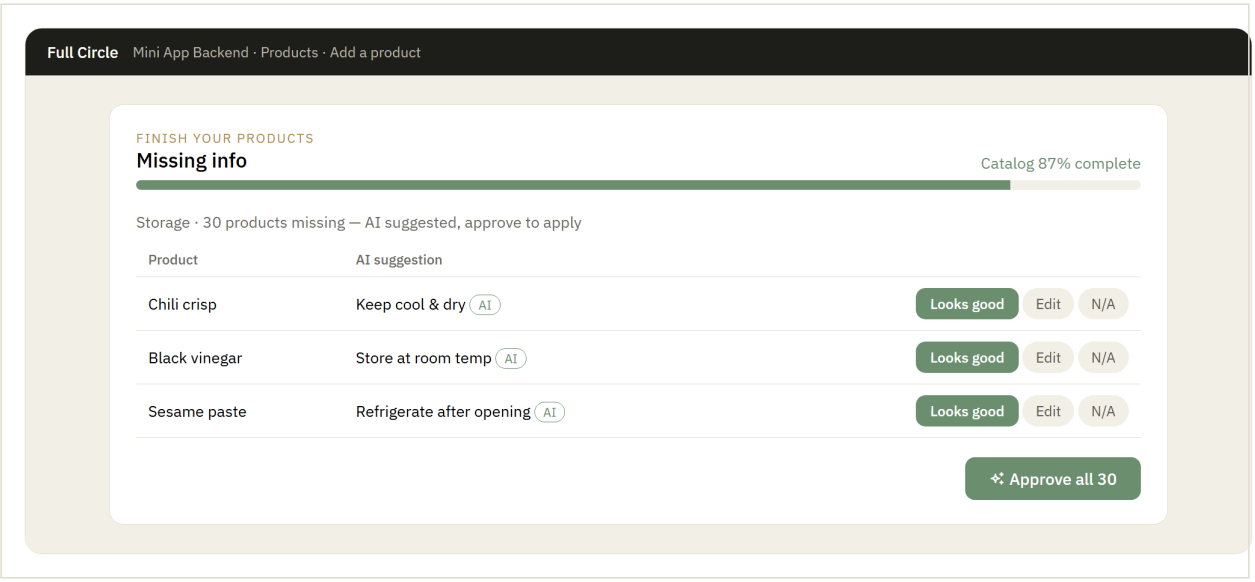
Step 2 — the one real fork. "Yes" moves price & stock per option.



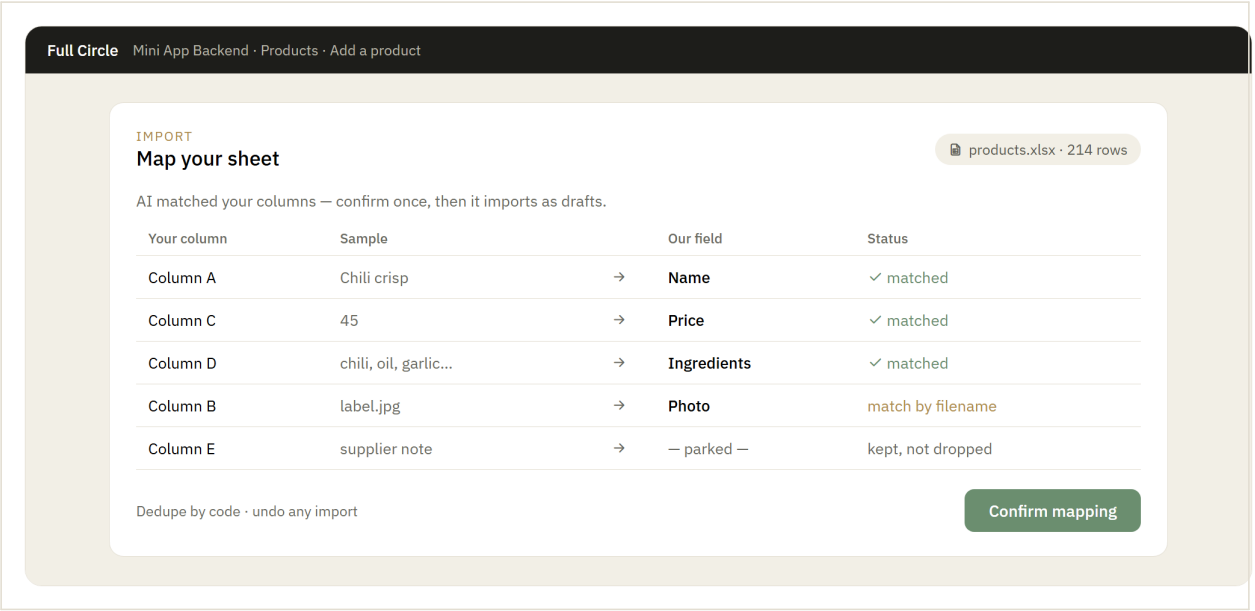
Step 3 — Details. One paste fills the facts; you glance and confirm.



Step 4 — Review & publish. Designed page is the default; draft-first.



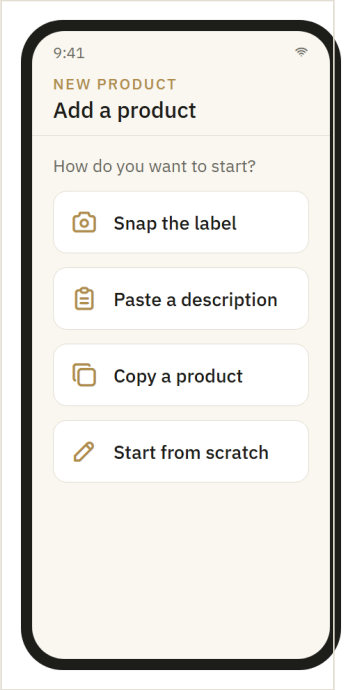
Finish — a gap queue batched by field. Approve the AI, don't type.



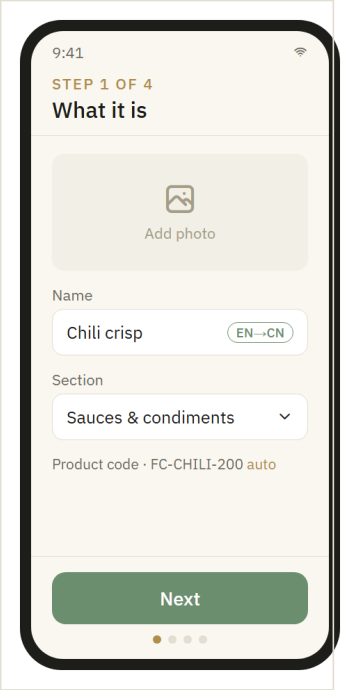
Import — AI maps any sheet to our fields; confirm once, lands as drafts.

Phone flow — the same loop in your pocket

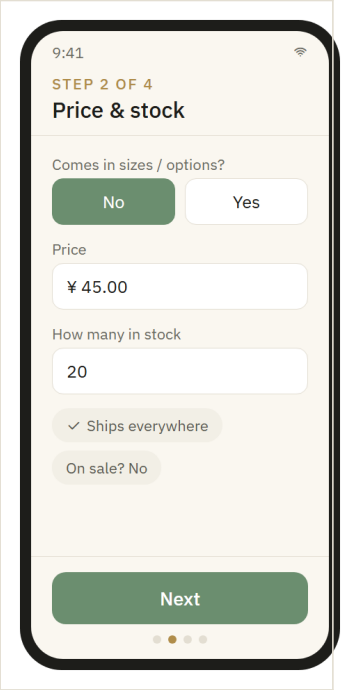
Each step on a phone, thumb-friendly — for operators adding products on the move.



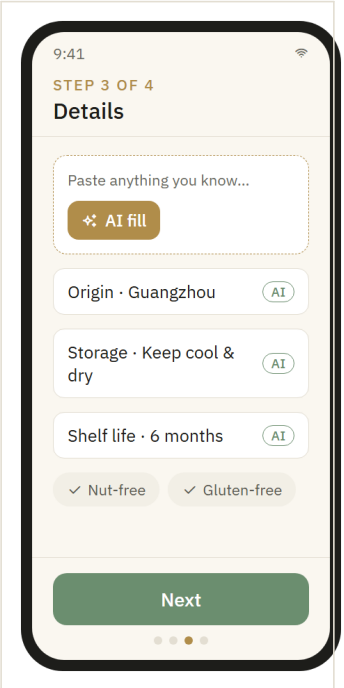
Front door



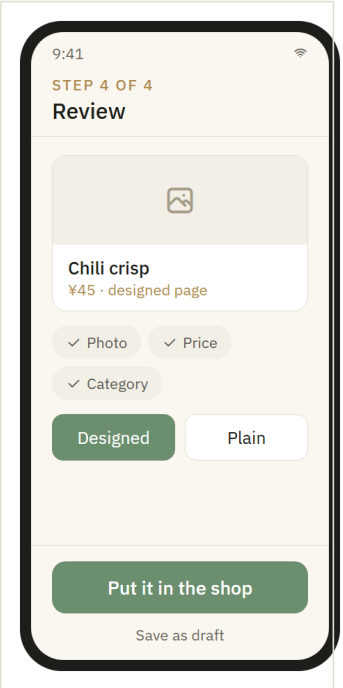
Step 1 · What it is



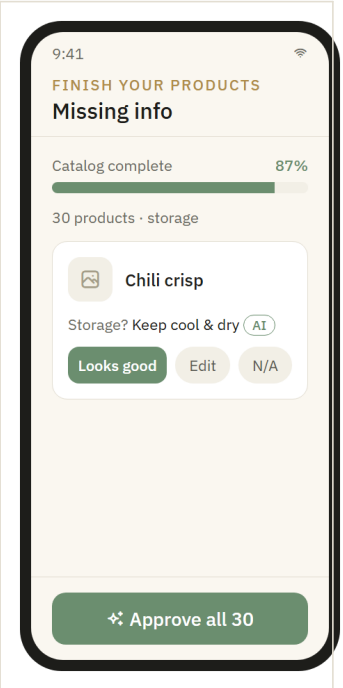
Step 2 · Price & stock



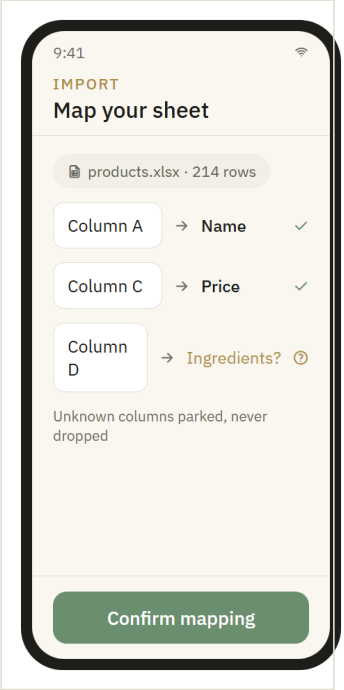
Step 3 · Details



Step 4 · Review



Finish · missing info



Import · map a sheet